Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday, September 26, 2022

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Councillors	M. Crawford
		J. Dies
		S. Lee
		R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 9:01 a.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the following minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Regular Meeting of June 20, 2022;
- Special Meeting of June 30, 2022;
- Closed Session Meeting of June 30, 2022;
- Special Meeting of July 5, 2022; and
- Closed Session Meeting of July 5, 2022.

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/ Clerk, noted that no questions had been received regarding the contents of the meeting agenda.

5. Delegations and Presentations

5.1 Delegation & Proclamation: October: Neurodiversity Education and Neurodivergent Acceptance Month

Karen Timm, Co-Founder of Neurodivergent Infinity Network of Educators, delivered a presentation on Neurodiversity Education and Neurodivergent Acceptance Month. K. Timm reviewed the purpose and mandate of Neurodivergent Infinity Network of Educators (NINE) and community outreach initiatives. Via pre-recorded presentation, Jaclyn, Durham District School Board teacher, shared her lived experience and perspective, and discussed the important role of NINE. K. Timm noted that the proclamation request aligns with ADHD Awareness Month, Autism Awareness Month in Canada, and International AAC Awareness Month and discussed the importance of education, accessibility and acceptance, and resources available.

Council Members asked how they can best support this initiative. K. Timm responded to the question from Council Members.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed October 2022 as Neurodiversity Education and Neurodivergent Acceptance Month in the Town of Ajax.

5.2 **Delegation: Accessibility Advisory Committee End-of-Term Summary Report**

Sepelene Deonarine, 2022 Committee Chair, presented a summary report of the activities of the Accessibility Advisory Committee for 2022. S. Deonarine reviewed the mandate of the Committee, highlights for the year including installation of beach access mats at Paradise Park, 'DRT Ride with the Mayor', barrier removal and installation of parks communication boards, community engagement and awareness initiatives namely the Unmasking Brain Injury Art Exhibit, Guide Dog awareness Month and #RespectTheSpace campaigns, and plans for 2023.

Council Members asked questions regarding nominations for the Regional Accessibility Awards and status of recommendations identified during 'DRT Ride with the Mayor'. S. Deonarine responded to questions from Council Members.

Mayor Collier thanked S. Deonarine for her presentation and commended the Accessibility Advisory Committee for all the hard work that they do.

5.3 **Delegation: Heritage Advisory Committee End-of-Term Summary Report**

Jeff Wood, 2022 Committee Chair, presented a summary of the activities of the Heritage Advisory Committee for 2022. J. Wood reviewed 2022 consultation highlights including monument restoration and door and window restoration at Gordon House, public outreach and education, Heritage Minute videos, heritage preservation, and Ajax Archives.

Council Members asked questions regarding the monument stabilization project at Elizabeth Street Cemetery, future Heritage Minute Videos, and exterior signage approvals. J. Wood responded to questions from Council Members.

Mayor Collier thanked J. Wood for his presentation and all members of the Committee for their contribution to preserving the history and heritage of Ajax.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence items 6.5 and 6.18 for discussion.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the balance of the report (Items 6.1, 6.2, 6.3, 6.4, 6.6, 6.7, 6.8, 6.9, 6.10, 6.11, 6.12, 6.13, 6.14, 6.15, 6.16, 6.17, 6.19, 6.20 and 6.21) dated September 26, 2022 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 6.5

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: S. Lee

That Item 6.5 (The Regional Municipality of Durham – Request to Ban Single-Use Plastic Shopping Bags) of the Correspondence Report be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 6.18

Council Members discussed the correspondence, noting that they support the concerns highlighted by Dr. Stas related to Pickering-Ajax Hospital.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Item 6.18 (Dr. Romas V. Stas – Open Letter to Premier Ford – Health Care in Ontario) of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1. Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

7.1.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee, September 6, 2022

Regional Councillor Dies abstained from voting due to her declared pecuniary interest with respect to item 4.2, as she has family that reside at 290 Old Harwood Avenue.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated September 6, 2022, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.2. General Government Committee Report

7.2.2 General Government Committee, September 12, 2022

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the General Government Committee Report dated September 12, 2022, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated September 26, 2022, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 Departmental Reports

7.4.1. CAO-2022-12: 2022 Strategic Plan Final Report

Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, provided an overview of the results and achievements of the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan, noting 100% completion of the Strategic Plan including the Top 22 by 2022 actions identified by the community.

Council Members asked questions regarding the status of the 'Stronger Together Community Champion' program, staff involvement in the development of the Strategic Plan, action items moved out to 2022-2026 term, and community engagement initiatives. C. McLardie responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan Final Report be received for information.

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Council Members noted that Durham Regional Council is scheduled to review changes related to sanitary sewer service connections on private property and the Service Line Warranties of Canada (SLWC) program at the September 28, 2022 Regional Council meeting. Members noted that the Municipality of Clarington's clear garbage bag pilot program has been deferred and Durham Region Transit resumed service on Route 211 (Ravenscroft Road, Church Street and Pickering Parkway). Members discussed the success of the Feed the Need initiative.

Council Members asked questions regarding transition of the Blue Box Program and Miller Waste contract renewal. Regional Councillor Crawford responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of September 26, 2022 be received for information.
CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Crawford assumed the Chair.

9.1 Support for the Federal Electoral Boundary Review as it Relates to Ajax

Regional Councillor Lee and Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

WHEREAS under the Constitution of Canada, the federal electoral districts must be reviewed every 10-years following the census to reflect changes and movements in Canada's population;

AND WHEREAS the Federal Electoral Boundaries Commission ("the Commission") for Ontario was allocated one additional district for the province (totaling 122 electoral districts) and found it necessary to propose many new electoral boundaries to correct wide variations in voter equality due to population changes;

AND WHEREAS because of population change, the Commission is proposing adding a sixth riding to the Eastern GTA and changing the boundaries to the existing five ridings, except for Ajax which remains unchanged. With the boundary changes to the Eastern GTA proposed electoral districts, the range of most populous to least populous riding varies by 7,799, ensuring fair representation by population;

AND WHEREAS by keeping the federal electoral district boundary in line with the Town of Ajax boundary the federal riding representative will be equipped to take a singular focus in speaking and acting on behalf of the people of Ajax;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council support the Commission's decision to leave the Ajax federal electoral district unchanged; and

2. A copy of this motion be sent to Commission Secretary Paula Puddy, and Ajax MP Mark Holland.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

10. By-laws

Council Members asked if there were any subsequent changes to the Parkland Dedication By-law. Sean McCullough, Supervisor, Planning Policy & Research, responded to the question from Council Members, noting no substantive changes to the by-law.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That By-law numbers 54-2022 to 63-2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.
CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities including Ajax Candidate Meet & Greets hosted by Carea Community Health Centre (CAREA) and Community Development Council Durham for the Ward 1 Candidates (at McLean Community Centre), Ward 2 Candidates (at Audley Recreation Centre), and Ward 3 Candidates (at Ajax Community Centre) on October 3, October 5 and October 13, 2022, respectively, and community forums hosted by Christian Faith Outreach Centre and CAREA under the theme 'Making Every Voice Heard' for the Mayoral and Ward 3 Councillors on September 28 and October 5, 2022, respectively, at Ajax Community Centre.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: J. Dies

That By-law number 64-2022 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on September 26, 2022, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the September 26, 2022 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (10:26 a.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

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D-Clerk